were signed for Housing Project, on cooperation in the field of Agriculture, and also a MoU between Telecom Regulatory Authority of India and Telecommunication Regulatory Commission.

The External Affairs Minister visited China on 8 February 2012. They reviewed the outstanding issues in Indo-China relations and agreed to work towards resolving them. To take the relations beyond bilateral cooperation they agreed that these irritants do not adversely affect the growing cooperation in other areas. Both sides pledged to carry that forward into 2012 and agreed to mark as the **"Year of India-China Friendship and Cooperation."**

The External Affairs Minister also visited Egypt and Singapore in early March 2012. The Prime Minister of India, Dr. Manmohan Singh paid an official visit to the Republic of Korea (ROK), at the invitation of President Lee Myung-bak, on 25 March 2012. The *India-Republic of Korea Joint Statement: Deepening the Strategic Partnership* upheld the multi-faceted bilateral relationship, which has rapidly acquired greater depth and vitality since its elevation to a Strategic Partnership during the landmark State visit to India of President of ROK in 2010 and State visit of President Pratibha Devisingh Patil to the Republic of Korea in July 2011. They expressed satisfaction at the increasing high-level exchanges, growing economic, trade, security and cultural ties, as well as people-to-people exchanges. The two leaders also held wide-ranging discussions on regional, international and multilateral issues. This visit was followed by signing of an agreement and MoU, (i) Agreement on Simplification of Visa Procedures, (ii) MoU on Cooperation between KNDA (Korea National Diplomatic Academy) and FSI (Foreign Service Institute).

Prime Minister Dr. Manmohan Singh visited Seoul on 27 March 2012, to attend the Nuclear Security Summit. He presented the national progress report. He upheld that India supports implementation of the Washington Summit Communiqué and Work Plan. India contributed to the NSS process, including hosting of a meeting of the Sherpas in New Delhi 16–17 January 2012.

The External Affairs Minister visited Russia on 13 April 2012 to attend the Eleventh Trilateral Meeting of the Foreign Ministers of India, Russia and China. The Joint Communiqué of the Eleventh